



RCCG OCEANIA

Evangelism & Mission

SENT BY JESUS IN GOD'S LOVE

AT A GLANCE

BIG IDEA

The same Jesus who is worthy of "hallelujah" and "praise the Lord" also speaks a commission: "As the Father has sent Me, I also send you." His sending is rooted in God's love, empowered by faith for meaningful works, and strengthened by the promise that He has prepared a place for His people. This study traces those themes through key moments and promises in John's Gospel.

PRIMARY PASSAGES

John 20:21

John 3:16

John 14:12

John 14:2

John 18:1

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Our mission begins in God's love revealed in giving His Son (John 3:16).

Jesus directly commissions His disciples to be sent as He was sent (John 20:21).

Faith in Jesus is linked with continuing His work in the world (John 14:12).

Hope is sustained by Jesus' promise that He has prepared a place for His people (John 14:2).

Following Jesus' path includes moving forward in obedience even when facing pressure (John 18:1).

Praise ("hallelujah," "praise the Lord") is not an end in itself; it leads into trusting and obeying Jesus' words.

INTRODUCTION

Worship rightly lifts the heart to say "hallelujah" and "praise the Lord." Yet Scripture also shows that true praise matures into trust and obedience. John's Gospel ties together God's love, the call to believe, Jesus' clear commission to be sent, the works that flow from faith, the hope of a place Jesus has prepared, and the example of Christ moving forward in obedience when His mission becomes most costly. This study is designed to help believers move from admiration of Jesus to participation in His purposes—rooted in love, guided by His words, and strengthened by hope.

SCRIPTURE READING

John 3:16 — Jesus explains that God's love is shown in giving His Son so that whoever will believe will not perish but have eternal life. God's love is the motive and foundation of salvation.

John 20:21 — After His resurrection, Jesus speaks peace and then gives a direct commission: just as the Father sent Him, He sends His disciples. The mission is explicit and personal.

John 14:12 — Jesus teaches His disciples that believing in Him is connected to doing works that continue His ministry. Faith is not merely internal; it expresses itself in obedient action.

SCRIPTURE READING (CONT.)

John 14:2 — Jesus comforts His followers with hope: there are many rooms in His Father's house, and He goes to prepare a place for His people. Future promise steadies present faithfulness.

John 18:1 — As events intensify toward Jesus' arrest, He goes forward into the garden. The scene highlights deliberate, purposeful movement into what is difficult—obedience under pressure.

KEY POINTS

- 1. LOVE AS THE STARTING POINT** — John 3:16 places God's love at the beginning of everything: God gives His Son, and people are invited to believe. The origin of Christian life is not human initiative, moral performance, or religious striving, but God's prior love. Because God has already acted in love, the believer's life becomes a response. Praise such as "hallelujah" and "praise the Lord" is fitting, but it is meant to deepen into trusting what God has done and receiving what He offers. Mission also starts here. Being sent is not an attempt to earn God's favor; it is participation flowing from God's gift. When love is the starting point, obedience becomes gratitude rather than self-promotion.
 - Write a short prayer that begins with God's love in John 3:16 and responds with trust: "God, because You loved and gave, I will believe."
 - Identify one area where serving others feels like "earning," and reframe it as response to God's love.
 - Practice praise that leads to action: after saying "praise the Lord," name one specific step of obedience you will take that day.

Scripture: John 3:16

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

2. JESUS' COMMISSION: YOU ARE SENT — In John 20:21, Jesus does not leave His disciples with only comfort; He gives direction: "As the Father has sent Me, I also send you." The pattern of Jesus' own sending becomes the framework for the disciple's life. This commission means Christian faith is more than private spirituality. Jesus sends His people outward as representatives of His purpose, carrying His peace and aligning with His mission. Being "sent" implies intentionality. It invites believers to see daily relationships, responsibilities, and opportunities as places to live out Jesus' words with faithfulness.

- Pray through John 20:21 and specifically offer yourself to Jesus' sending in your ordinary routines.
- Choose one relationship where you can represent Jesus' peace through a humble conversation or act of service.
- Make a simple "sent" plan for the week: one act of kindness, one truthful encouragement, and one moment of prayer for someone else.

Scripture: John 20:21

3. FAITH THAT WORKS — John 14:12 links believing in Jesus with doing works. Belief is not presented as mere agreement; it is living trust that results in action aligned with Jesus' ministry. The focus is not self-glory. Works that flow from believing are meant to continue Jesus' purposes—obedience to His words, compassionate engagement with people, and a life that reflects His character. This helps clarify the movement from praise into practice. "Hallelujah" is not just a word spoken; it becomes a life that believes Jesus enough to follow Him in concrete ways.

- Name one "work" consistent with Jesus' character that you can do this week (serve, encourage, help, reconcile).
- When fear or hesitation rises, repeat the connection in John 14:12: "I believe; therefore I will act in obedience."
- Review your motivations: ask God to purify your service so it aligns with Jesus rather than personal recognition.

Scripture: John 14:12

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

4. HOPE OF A PREPARED PLACE — John 14:2 grounds discipleship in hope. Jesus promises that there are many rooms in His Father's house and that He goes to prepare a place. This is not escape from responsibility; it is strength for perseverance. Hope matters because being sent includes waiting, labor, and sometimes disappointment. The promise of a prepared place reminds believers that Jesus' care is personal and purposeful, and that the future is held by Him. This hope enables steady obedience. The believer can serve faithfully without panic, because Jesus' promise gives meaning and direction beyond present outcomes.

- Memorize John 14:2 and use it in prayer when weariness or discouragement appears.
- Let hope reshape your priorities: choose one act of faithfulness that may not bring immediate results, and do it anyway.
- Encourage someone with the promise of John 14:2, emphasizing Jesus' preparation and care.

Scripture: John 14:2

5. OBEDIENCE UNDER PRESSURE — John 18:1 shows Jesus moving forward as His mission reaches a painful turning point. The setting underscores deliberate obedience rather than retreat. Jesus does not stumble into difficulty; He advances in faithfulness. Those who are sent by Jesus should expect that obedience can involve pressure. Being sent does not guarantee ease, but it does anchor discipleship in Jesus' example of forward trust. Obedience under pressure is not stubbornness; it is surrendered resolve. Praise becomes courageous faith: "praise the Lord" even when the path is hard, because Jesus is worthy and trustworthy.

- Identify one area where pressure tempts you to withdraw from obedience; ask God for strength to take the next faithful step.
- Practice a simple habit of forward obedience: do one difficult but right action promptly rather than delaying.
- Pray for someone facing hardship, asking that they would follow Jesus' pattern of faithful movement forward.

Scripture: John 18:1

GROUP DISCUSSION

Tip: Use these questions to guide the group from seeing → understanding → applying.

OBSERVATION

- In John 3:16, what actions are attributed to God, and what response is described for people?
- In John 20:21, what comparison does Jesus make between His own sending and the disciples' sending?
- In John 14:12, what connection is made between believing in Jesus and doing works?
- In John 14:2, what does Jesus say He is doing, and what does that imply about His relationship to His people?
- In John 18:1, what does Jesus' movement into the scene suggest about His posture toward His mission?

INTERPRETATION

How does starting with God's love (John 3:16) protect mission from becoming self-driven achievement?

What might it mean in practical terms to be sent "as" Jesus was sent (John 20:21) without adding ideas beyond the verse?

How can John 14:12 be understood as a call to obedience that flows from belief rather than a demand for self-exalting activity?

How does the promise of a prepared place (John 14:2) shape endurance and courage in the present?

What does Jesus' example in John 18:1 teach about obedience when pressure increases?

APPLICATION

- Where is it easiest for praise (“hallelujah,” “praise the Lord”) to stop at words rather than leading into obedience? What change would help?
- What is one specific way you can live as someone who is sent this week, in a normal setting and relationship?
- What “work” (John 14:12) could you do that clearly expresses believing Jesus—without seeking recognition?
- When discouragement rises, how can John 14:2 become a practical source of hope rather than a distant idea?
- What pressure are you facing that could tempt you to retreat? What would a forward step of obedience look like, following Jesus’ example (John 18:1)?

PRAYER FOCUS

Thank God for His love shown in giving His Son, and ask for deeper trust to truly believe. Offer yourself to Jesus’ sending, asking for courage and clarity to represent His peace in everyday life.

Ask for strength to do the works that flow from faith with pure motives and humble obedience.

Pray for endurance under pressure, anchored in the hope of the place Jesus has prepared.

NEXT STEP

Prayerfully identify one place you are being sent today and take one concrete step of obedient service or witness that reflects Jesus’ love and peace.

CONCLUSION

John's Gospel holds these truths together: God's love gives, believers are called to believe, Jesus commissions His disciples to be sent, faith expresses itself through obedient works, and hope is sustained by the promise of a prepared place. The path of being sent may include pressure, yet Jesus models faithful forward movement. Let praise rise sincerely—"hallelujah," "praise the Lord"—and let it mature into trusting Jesus' words and walking in the mission He assigns.